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MakerBot, 3D Systems, ShopBot and Arduino came in for technical assistance. So suddenly, all the mom and pops styled stores were on a level playing field when it came to quality thanks to additive manufacturing that brought democracy to the factory. In fact, they could give users something their giant counterparts couldn't – customised attention to detail.

All consumers needed to do was head to Adafruit, Kickstarter, Indiegogo, Etsy or even eBay to buy, sometimes even before the production run was planned out. For the

\$33.7 billion eBay, their decision to stock independent maker's goods right next to those manufactured by large chains in the cyber bazaar is telling.

It's always time to take a possible revolution seriously when the money bags start noticing it. In 2013, GE launched FirstBuild, an open platform for designers, artistes, technologists and the next guy to collaborate on ideas to refine existing GE products. Tapping into the maker culture is high on the agenda for corporates who like to throw around the word "disruptive" when referencing the maker movement.

To get back briefly to the guys at hackathons who had built for themselves a physical space to hack called hackerspaces, they experienced the natural progression to require hardware to support the software they used. Here, hackerspaces began to introduce tools such as hand tools, power tools and additive manufacturing tools. The word 'maker' was still unheard of.

There is a considerable amount of urban lore about how the term 'maker movement' came to be. One such tale starts off with a man named Dale Dougherty, founder of Maker Media that publishes the infamous MAKE magazine which came out with its first edition in 2005 in California. The bi-monthly which aimed to document the work of DIY enthusiasts and hands-on tinkerers of technology was to be called Hack originally. It was Dougherty's daughter, legend has it, who suggested 'Make' since the word hack had been sufficiently used to label software tinkerers. As the premier voice of makers in America where the movement metaphorically caught